

2c. Content of Dimensions of linguistic variation (Component 02)

Dimensions of linguistic variation (Component 02) covers the topics of how children acquire language, language in the media, and how language changes over time.

There are three sections in this component:

- Section A: Child language acquisition
- Section B: Language in the media
- Section C: Language change.

Dimensions of linguistic variation		
Section	Topic coverage	Learners should be able to:
A: Child language acquisition The focus of this section is on children's acquisition of spoken language. The age range to be explored is 0–7 years old.	Learners focus on linguistic analysis of a short sample of authentic children's spoken text. Some aspects of spoken text will be transcribed phonemically, using symbols from the International Phonetic Alphabet (IPA). A copy of the IPA is found in Section 5c and will be included in the exam paper. Learners should develop their analysis of linguistic features in the text with reference to theoretical concepts of child language acquisition to aid interpretation of the data.	• show knowledge and understanding of the language levels, including: – phonetics, phonology and prosodics: how speech sounds and effects are articulated and analysed – lexis and semantics: the vocabulary of English – grammar, including morphology: the structural patterns and shapes of English at sentence, clause, phrase and word level – pragmatics: the contextual aspects of language use – discourse: extended stretches of communication occurring in different genres, modes and contexts • apply knowledge of the language levels (above) to a range of contexts for language use, including social and individual varieties of English and aspects of language and identity • apply language concepts and methods of analysis appropriately and systematically to data • apply critical skills in close reading, description, evaluation, analysis and interpretation of texts and discourses • use accurately a range of terminology associated with the study of language • make accurate references to texts and sources.